



OVERLAPPING ACTIVITIES: TEACHERS AND STUDENTS SEEK FOR A SOLUTION

The academic landscape is increasingly challenging, with students and teachers grappling with a central dilemma: overlapping activities, severe time constraints, and resulting exhaustion. This confluence of demands, often involving high-stakes extracurricular coinciding with essential academic requirements, strains the resources and well-being of the entire school community.



The main problem stems from a packed schedule that doesn't account for the necessary time and mental space required for the both core learning and specialized activities, creating a system under constant stress, as reported by various educational analysis and institutional reports outlining the pressures in the K-12 system.

EXTRACURRICULAR DEMANDS

The school calendar is punctuated by an array of extracurricular activities that, while beneficial, often compete for time, including events like the Division Schools Press Conference (DSPC), legislative debates, science EXPO competition, and extensive athletic schedules.

These activities requires significant commitments, involving rigorous preparation, travel, and competition days that pull both students and teachers-coaches away from regular class schedule. DepEd Order No. 66, s. 2017 on implementing guidelines on the conduct off-campus activities, for instance,

confirms the necessity for such activities to align with learning outcomes but also requires adherence to strict protocols, indirectly validating the substantial time commitment needed from participants and organizers. The high frequency of this largescale events, as noted in DepEd school circulars, further underscores the pressure on the systems schedule.

THE TEACHER'S PERSPECTIVE: NO CHOICE BUT TO COPE



Teachers share a similar plight, often viewing the pile-up of responsibilities as overlapping works where they "don't have a choice," but to comply with the demands of the system.

They are frequently tasked not only with their core six hours of actual classroom teaching but also with coaching, training, and completing extensive administrative paperwork related to this extracurriculars.

DepEd Order No. 005, s. 2024 and DM No. 053, s. 2024 address the rationalization of teacher workload, reaffirming that the remaining two hours of the mandated eight-hour workday are for "work incident to the normal teaching duties.,

or students the struggle is palpable and multifaceted, as the core issue of overlapping activities directly leads to them feeling exhausted, and suffering from profound lack of time. Studies on academic overload, such as those published in the EPRA Journals, show that the overloaded school events negatively affects students' physical health by causing exhaustion, disrupted sleep patterns, and increased stress, which the impacts their academic focus. From student surveys indicate that the overabundance of activities for students to isolate themselves mentally as they focus solely on finishing their work, leading to decreased confidence and difficulties in completing assignments and exams on time.

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“A PROBLEM THAT SHOULD NOT BE IGNORED”

NI: RAINNE BANATE

Money that used to be enough for daily needs is no longer sufficient today. Many people are now forced to cut expenses for education and health just to stretch their monthly budget and cope with poverty. The rising prices of goods are caused by various factors such as global oil prices, supply chain issues, and lack of food production. Often, the government and the private sector have a role in regulating prices, but their efforts are not always enough to protect the citizens.

At the family level, proper budgeting and saving can help lessen the immediate impact of price increases. Inflation, or the rise in the cost of goods, is a challenge that cannot be ignored. It is time to become informed and prepared for expenses, while collectively calling for measures that will help our people. With the right information, discipline, and support for the local economy, the effects of rising prices on every family can be eased. Through cooperation and unity, we can achieve real change in our country.

At present, one of the biggest issues in the country is the continuous increase in the prices of goods, or inflation. Every day, citizens notice that food, transportation fare, and other basic needs are becoming more expensive. This problem affects every family, especially those who are poor.

Many families struggle to buy their necessities because of the ongoing inflation. Students, workers, and ordinary families feel its effects. As a result, they experience stress, depression, and worry about their future.

According to reports from the PSA and the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas, the inflation rate has increased by 3% this year. Many products, from rice to gasoline, have gone up in price. We need enough support from our government to help families who are suffering in our country.

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CNHS STUDENTS LEAD THE FIGHT AGAINST PLASTIC WASTE!

NI: RAINNE BANATE

Although Cabadbaran City Ordinance No. 2020-037 has already been implemented, prohibiting the use of single-use plastic and cellophane, plastic waste continues to spread around Calamba National High School (CNHS). However, the students themselves have taken the lead in efforts to reduce plastic waste in their school.

According to Teacher Cresante Cresino, many students used to rely on plastic for their food and drinks, and these were often not disposed of properly. But today, a noticeable change can be seen as more students use reusable containers and tumblers.

“We can really see the change because many students are now using reusable containers and tumblers for their lunch and drinks,” Cresino stated.

Teachers and discipline are said to be the motivation behind the students’ initiative to stop using plastic and cellophane.

“The lessons taught by our teachers about the importance of caring for the environment truly stayed in our minds. We also see how unpleasant it looks when the streets are filled with scattered plastic and cellophane,” said Kyra Lamdagan.

“It also becomes costly to keep buying plastic and cellophane every time we eat lunch,” Lamdagan added.

In support of the students’ efforts, EYONER CLUB, INC. donated 250 tumblers to CNHS to further encourage students to avoid single-use plastics. This initiative also promotes the use of eco-friendly lunch boxes and refillable water bottles. Nearly 90% of CNHS students now use tumblers. Meanwhile, during the GPTA meeting, Barangay Captain Junie B. Quiboy reminded parents and students that they play a significant role in caring for the environment.

“Everyone has a responsibility to our environment. We encourage the youth and their parents to help reduce plastic waste,” Quiboy stated.

This program not only helps protect the environment but also promotes discipline and awareness among students.

CNHS INTRAMURALS SUCCESSFULLY LAUNCHED, SUPPORTED BY SK OFFICIALS



The annual Intramurals of Calamba National High School (CNHS) was successfully held, supported by the Sangguniang Kabataan (SK) of Calamba, which provided ₱20,000 used for trophies, medals, sports equipment, and other event needs.

According to the school administration, the intramurals aim to encourage active student participation in sports and strengthen camaraderie within the school community.

All students, teachers, and SK members attended to ensure a smooth and enjoyable event.

Principal Maribeth C. Cabradilla emphasized that sports are not only about winning medals but also about the dedication, discipline, and proper attitude of every participant.

“It’s more than a medal—it’s a testament to dedication, discipline, and heart,” said Principal Cabradilla.

Athletes showcased their talents, demonstrating skill and sportsmanship.

The principal also expressed gratitude for the unwavering support of the SK officials in the school’s activities, highlighting the strong relationship between the barangay and the school.

“Thank you very much to our barangay officials, especially our SK, for the continuous support in all our school activities. This proves the strong bond between our school and the barangay,” she added.

This year’s intramurals served as an inspiration for everyone to continue their hard work and passion for sports.

NEW CNHS BUILDING TO PROVIDE BETTER AND
MORE COMFORTABLE LEARNING
ENVIRONMENT FOR STUDENTS

NI: RAINNE BANATE

A significant step toward improving the educational environment was achieved on October 22, 2025, with the formal inauguration of the new two-unit, single-story, two-classroom building of Calamba National High School (CNHS). Congressman Dale B. Corvera and Governor Maria Angelica Rosedell M. Amante led the ceremony as part of their commitment to enhancing education quality and ensuring the comfort of Calamba students. The project, a product of the “Unified Leadership in Agusan del Norte,” stands as proof of the unity and concern of the province’s leaders for the welfare of the youth.

The new building is expected to help reduce classroom congestion, provide students with a better learning environment, and further strengthen their motivation to study. Present at the historic event were Congressman Corvera, Mayor Judy Chin Amante, Schools Division Superintendent Imelda N. Sabornido, Hon. Junie Quiboy and members of the Barangay Council, as well as representatives from the SPTA, SSLG, and other school sectors. According to Congressman Corvera, this project is part of their continuous advocacy to provide every Agusanon child with a safer, more comfortable, and more effective learning space. “Buildings like this are investments for the future—here we will shape the next leaders of our nation,” he said.

Mayor Judy also emphasized the importance of every school that is built, as each one represents a fulfilled dream and a life that will be changed. “In every school we build, a dream comes true and a life is transformed,” said Mayor Judy. She also expressed her joy and gratitude for the heartfelt welcome given to her by CNHS students. At the close of the program, the CNHS administration extended their heartfelt gratitude to the leaders and partners who continuously support education. The new building is expected to serve as an inspiration not only to the students but to the entire community, encouraging everyone to uphold every child’s right to quality education.

CNHS INTRAMURALS
SUCCESSFULLY HELD,
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CALAMBA — The annual intramurals of Calamba National High School (CNHS) was successfully held, with strong support from the Sangguniang Kabataan (SK) of Calamba, which contributed ₱20,000 for trophies, medals, sports equipment, and other event necessities. According to the school administration, the intramurals aimed to encourage active student participation in sports and to strengthen camaraderie within the school. All students, teachers, and SK members attended the event to ensure a smooth and enjoyable program. Principal Maribeth C. Cabradilla emphasized that sports go beyond winning medals, highlighting dedication, discipline, and proper conduct among participants. "It's more than a medal—it's a testament to dedication, discipline, and heart," Principal Cabradilla said. Student-athletes showcased their talents, demonstrating skill, sportsmanship, and teamwork. The principal also expressed gratitude for the continuous support of the SK officials, emphasizing the strong partnership between the school and the barangay.

"We are truly grateful to our barangay officials, especially the SK, for their unwavering support in all our school activities. This proves the strong bond between our school and our community," she added. This year’s intramurals served as an inspiration for all students to continue striving for excellence and nurturing their love for sports.

CNHS INTRAMURALS
SUCCESSFULLY HELD,
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Despite the enforcement of Cabadbaran City Ordinance No. 2020-037, which bans the use of single-use plastics and cellophane, plastic waste continues to be seen around Calamba National High School (CNHS). However, students themselves have taken the lead in initiatives to reduce plastic use within their school. According to Teacher Cresante Cresino, many students used to rely heavily on plastic for food and drinks, often disposing of it improperly. Today, a shift is evident as more students are using reusable containers and tumblers. "We can see the change because many students now bring reusable containers and tumblers for their meals and drinks," Cresino said.

The guidance and discipline instilled by teachers have motivated students to adopt these environmentally friendly practices. "The lessons from our teachers about taking care of the environment really stick with us. We also see how unpleasant the streets look when they are full of scattered plastic and cellophane," said Kyra Lamdagan. She added that constantly buying disposable plastic for lunch can be costly. Supporting the students' initiative, EYONER CLUB, INC. donated 250 tumblers to CNHS to encourage the avoidance of single-use plastics. The program also promotes the use of eco-friendly lunch boxes and refillable water bottles, with nearly 90% of CNHS students now using tumblers.

During a recent GPTA meeting, Barangay Captain Junie B. Quiboy reminded parents and students of their vital role in protecting the environment. "Everyone has a responsibility to care for our surroundings. We encourage the youth and their parents to help reduce plastic waste," he said. The program not only benefits the environment but also fosters discipline and environmental awareness among students. CNHS's surroundings have become cleaner and more organized due to active student participation, setting an example for the wider community. Despite the challenges, these student-led initiatives demonstrate that the youth play a crucial role in creating a cleaner, safer, and more sustainable future.

NEW CNHS BUILDING PROVIDES A BETTER AND MORE
COMFORTABLE LEARNING ENVIRONMENT FOR STUDENTS

A significant step toward improving the educational environment was taken on October 22, 2025, with the formal inauguration of the new two-unit, single-story, two-classroom building of Calamba National High School (CNHS). The ceremony was led by Congressman Dale B. Corvera and Governor Maria Angelica Rosedell M. Amante, reflecting their commitment to enhancing the quality of education and ensuring the comfort of Calamba's students. The project, a result of the “Unified Leadership in Agusan del Norte”, stands as proof of the local leaders’ solidarity and concern for the welfare of the youth. It is expected to reduce overcrowding in classrooms, provide students with a more suitable learning space, and further boost their motivation to study. The historic occasion was attended by Congressman Corvera, Mayor Judy Chin Amante, Schools Division Superintendent Imelda N. Sabornido, Hon. Junie Quiboy, members of the Barangay Council, as well as representatives from SPTA, SSLG

, and other sectors of the school. According to Congressman Corvera, the project is part of their continuous advocacy to provide every Agusanon child with a safer, well-ventilated, and effective learning environment. "Buildings like this are an investment in the future—this is where the next leaders of our nation will be shaped," he said. Mayor Judy also emphasized the importance of every school that is built, noting that a dream is fulfilled and a life is transformed with each project. "In every school we establish, a dream comes true and a life is changed," she said. Mayor Judy also expressed her joy at the heartfelt welcome given by CNHS students during the event. At the conclusion of the program, the CNHS administration extended their sincere gratitude to the leaders and partners who continue to support education. The new building is expected to serve as an inspiration not only to the students but also to the entire community, encouraging everyone to uphold every child’s right to quality education.

A CALL FOR RESPONSIBILITY: PROTECTING OUR FUTURE

BY:
LARA A. NASOCWAO

Protecting the environment is no longer a choice—it is an urgent necessity. As Filipinos, we are blessed with abundant natural resources, and it is our responsibility to preserve and safeguard them. Our ecosystems are not only scenic landscapes; they are vital to our water supply, food security, and the overall economy. Human activities remain the primary cause of environmental degradation. Deforestation has left only about 3.2% of the country’s original forests intact. Pollution, especially from plastic waste, is another pressing concern, with around 2.7 million tons generated each year—20% of which ends up in our oceans. Illegal mining and industrial waste further exacerbate environmental damage, leaving communities vulnerable to floods, landslides, and other disasters.

The Philippines is among the most disaster-prone countries in the world. Evidence shows a rising incidence of floods, landslides, and droughts, worsened by human negligence and unsustainable practices. Immediate action is necessary. Promoting environmental responsibility is not just an ethical duty—it is a social and economic imperative. Preserving the environment requires adopting sustainable practices and initiatives that prioritize ecological responsibility. Individuals can contribute through simple yet effective actions: reducing and recycling waste, conserving water, using eco-friendly products, participating in reforestation, practicing organic agriculture, and managing land responsibly.

Small but consistent efforts create significant impact. Communities that embrace sustainability enjoy cleaner surroundings, improved public health, and heightened environmental awareness. Cultivating a culture of care and accountability strengthens resilience against natural disasters and fosters long-term environmental protection. Protecting the environment is a collective responsibility. Government agencies, private sectors, and citizens must collaborate to implement policies and programs that ensure sustainability. Public education, stricter law enforcement, and incentives for eco-friendly practices are essential tools in this mission. Neglecting environmental protection is no longer acceptable. Every action, no matter how small, contributes either to the destruction or preservation of our planet. Awareness, discipline, and proactive measures are key to shaping a sustainable and thriving future. Safeguarding the environment today ensures that future generations inherit a world that is healthy, vibrant, and capable of supporting life. Our vision for tomorrow is directly shaped by the choices we make today, and every citizen has a vital role to play. Ultimately, protecting the environment is a duty, not a choice. By embracing responsibility and sustainable practices, we can secure a safe, prosperous, and resilient future for our country and for generations yet to come.

FIGHTING CORRUPTION: A CALL FOR
TRANSPARENT GOVERNANCE

BY: LARA A. NASOCWAO



In today’s society, corruption is a challenge that continues to affect the Philippines. From the past to the present, news reports regularly expose allegations of fund mismanagement, theft, and dishonesty among public officials. Now is the time for Filipinos to stand up, speak out, and actively participate in meaningful change. One of the main reasons corruptions persists is the lack of strict enforcement and accountability among government officials. Many projects and budgets are mismanaged due to dishonesty, depriving citizens of essential public services and hindering the country’s progress. According to Republic Act No. 3019, or the Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act, all forms of corruption, including bribery and misuse of public funds, are prohibited. Despite changes in administration over the years, corruption remains a significant challenge. The time has come to promote transparency, unity, and genuine reform. The effects of corruption are felt in everyday life. Funds intended for education, healthcare, and public services often end up in the hands of a few, leaving ordinary citizens to bear the burden of inadequate support. Poverty deepens, and public trust in government continues to decline.

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THE EARTH NEEDS HEROES, NOT
BYSTANDERS

BY: RUVEI MHYR M. GURO

The worsening environmental crisis calls on all of us to act decisively and raise our voices to protect and preserve our society. Its consequences are far-reaching: widespread ecosystem destruction, climate change, and an increase in illnesses caused by pollution. Addressing these environmental challenges is essential not only for the well-being of our communities but also for securing a healthy and sustainable future for our nation. The root of the problem lies in the continued exploitation and abuse of natural resources. Illegal logging, unsustainable fishing practices, and industrial pollution are daily threats to our forests, rivers, and biodiversity. If we continue to ignore these issues, animal habitats will disappear, and human life will inevitably suffer the consequences. Legislation such as the Philippine Clean Air Act of 1999 aims to maintain air quality by regulating pollution sources and establishing environmental standards. Other programs, including the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act and the National Greening Program, also seek to conserve natural resources. These initiatives are essential for safeguarding the environment and ensuring a sustainable future. The government carries the responsibility of enforcing environmental laws and programs. Yet, the private sector must also demonstrate care and actively

contribute to reducing pollution. Even simple actions, such as planting trees and proper waste disposal, can significantly improve our surroundings. Improper waste management has serious consequences, including flooding and soil erosion. Educating the public on proper sanitation and cleanliness is therefore critical. Active participation in environmental advocacy not only protects the environment but also strengthens communities and promotes national development. To effectively address these challenges, we need broad-based educational campaigns, stricter enforcement of environmental laws, support for eco-friendly projects, and, most importantly, a change in mindset and lifestyle. Collective action is the key to solving these problems and preserving our environment for future generations. Protecting the environment requires the cooperation of everyone: government, private sector, and individuals. By working together, we can ensure that the natural resources that sustain our communities are maintained and preserved. Ultimately, the actions we take today determine the future of our nation. Through unity, knowledge, and care, we can safeguard our environment and ensure that future generations inherit a world that is healthy, vibrant, and resilient.



NATURE'S FURY, OUR RESPONSIBILITY

BY: RUVEI MHYR M. GURO

A devastating 6.9-magnitude earthquake recently struck the Visayas region, particularly Cebu City, on September 30, 2025. The tremor claimed 72 lives, injured hundreds, and left thousands of families displaced. Even a 139-year-old historic church in Bog0 City was reduced to rubble, a stark reminder of nature's unstoppable force. The tragedy highlights how vulnerable the Philippines remains to natural disasters. Positioned along the Pacific Ring of Fire, the country faces constant threats from earthquakes, typhoons, and volcanic eruptions. Yet, despite past experiences, many communities still lack adequate preparedness and resilient systems to reduce casualties and damage.

News reports and social media footage showed the panic and desperation of residents crying out for water, food, and medical assistance. While the earthquake has passed, the emotional scars and trauma remain. Disasters do not only destroy buildings—they leave lasting impacts on people's lives and well-being. The government and local authorities must strengthen the Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) system to respond effectively in times of crisis. Emergency plans should be not just documented but actively practiced, ensuring that communities understand and can follow them when disaster strikes.

Education is also a critical component of preparedness. Schools must conduct regular earthquake drills and disaster preparedness activities, teaching students practical knowledge on evacuation, first aid, and safety measures. Awareness saves lives, and instilling it early ensures that future generations are better prepared. Infrastructure must be designed and reinforced to withstand natural calamities. Aging buildings, bridges, and schools require retrofitting and inspection to minimize risk. The principle of "build back better" should guide reconstruction, ensuring that repaired structures are safer and more resilient than before.

Citizens have an equally important role. Community participation, volunteerism, and cooperation strengthen the response to disasters. Preparedness is a shared responsibility; everyone—government, communities, and individuals—must work together to reduce the impact of nature's fury. The recent earthquake is a powerful reminder: nature's fury is beyond human control, but our response is within our hands. By fostering a culture of preparedness, solidarity, and resilience, we can face calamities with courage and minimize their toll. Together, we can build a safer, stronger, and more resilient Philippines.

RIISING PRICES, RISING CONCERNS: TIME TO ACT

BY: RUVEI MHYR M. GURO

Currently, one of the most pressing issues in the country is the continuous rise in the prices of goods, also known as inflation. Every day, citizens notice that the cost of food, transportation, and other essential needs keeps increasing. This problem affects every family, especially those in low-income communities who struggle to meet their daily needs.

Many families are finding it increasingly difficult to afford basic necessities due to persistent inflation. Students, workers, and ordinary households feel the impact on their daily lives. As a result, stress, anxiety, and even depression have become common as families worry about their future.

According to the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) and the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas, the inflation rate has risen by 3% this year. Many products, from rice to gasoline, have increased in price. The effects are most severely felt by citizens with low or limited income.

Because of inflation, the number of impoverished families in the country has grown. Money that once covered daily expenses now barely lasts. Many households are forced to reduce spending on education and healthcare just to make ends meet. This situation underscores the urgent need for government support and intervention.

The rise in prices is caused by several factors, including global oil prices, supply chain disruptions, and shortages in food production. While the government and private sector have roles in regulating prices, these measures are often insufficient to protect citizens from sudden price surges.

As responsible citizens, especially young people, it is essential to be aware of the effects of inflation. Proper budgeting and saving at home are necessary skills that cannot be ignored. Staying informed about government policies that influence the prices of essential goods is equally important.

To lessen the impact of inflation, several solutions can be implemented. Price monitoring of essential goods, stronger support for local farmers and small businesses, and measures to reduce production costs are crucial. At the family level, careful budgeting and prudent spending can help households cope with rising prices while maintaining a decent standard of living.

Inflation is a challenge that cannot be ignored. It is time to be informed, prepared, and proactive in managing household expenses. With the right information, discipline, and support for the local economy, families can reduce the effects of rising prices and safeguard their future.

Ultimately, addressing inflation requires collective effort. Through cooperation, awareness, and responsible actions, citizens and government alike can work toward a more stable economy. By facing this challenge together, we can ensure that families remain resilient and prepared for the uncertainties of everyday life.

“DROWNED BOOKS, UNBROKEN DREAMS”

The wind howled like a wounded beast, lashing at every roof and rattling every window. The night sky turned pitch black as Typhoon Tino unleashed its fury over Barangay Antonio Luna. Amid the storm’s terrifying roar, a young girl named Jessa clung tightly to her mother, her small heart trembling in fear. “What will happen to us?” she whispered, as rain poured endlessly from the heavens. Outside, the storm showed no mercy. Trees bent low, roofs were ripped apart, and floodwaters swallowed the roads. In just hours, Jessa’s small house once filled with warmth and laughter was buried beneath muddy water. Her notebooks, pencils, and school bag floated away, symbols of dreams momentarily washed by the flood. But even as her tears mixed with the rain, she refused to lose hope.

That night, Jessa and her family joined dozens of others inside the barangay classroom a temporary shelter for the storm’s survivors. The air was cold and heavy with fear, yet the warmth of kindness began to rise. Families shared food, mothers comforted crying children, and fathers secured tarpaulins to block the leaking corners. In that crowded room, unity became their strongest roof. “The storm may have taken our homes,” the barangay captain said softly, “but it can never take our courage.” His words echoed in the hearts of everyone present. People prayed together, cried together, and hoped together a true portrait of Filipino resilience shining amid darkness.



At dawn, volunteers arrived carrying food packs, clothes, and blankets. Some residents, despite losing everything, offered to help distribute supplies. Others joined rescue teams, risking their safety to help neighbors still stranded. The spirit of bayanihan that unbreakable thread of Filipino compassion bound everyone in the face of adversity. Days after the typhoon, Jessa returned to the ruins of her home. Her school uniform was soaked and torn, her books unreadable. Yet she picked up a mud-stained pencil and smiled faintly. “I’ll still go to school,” she said. “No storm can stop me from learning.” In that single moment, her courage became a quiet light of hope for her entire community.

Life in Barangay Antonio Luna slowly began to rebuild. Neighbors helped each other clean the streets, children played again under the bright morning sun, and laughter slowly replaced the cries of fear. The same storm that destroyed their homes built something far stronger unity, compassion, and faith. Typhoon Tino may have tested their strength, but it also revealed their hearts. Jessa and her neighbors learned that the greatest power of all is not found in walls or roofs, but in the love that keeps people standing even when everything else has fallen. And as Jessa gazed at the horizon, clutching her salvaged pencil, she whispered with a smile, “The storm may have drowned my books, but not my dreams

“THE GIRL WHO WALKED TO SUCCEED”

BY: JAMES HERMIE EVARDO

Before the first light of dawn touches Tagbongabong, RTR, Agusan del Norte, Ritchel Seballo is already on her feet. Her worn-out sleepers slap softly against the dusty road, marking the start of a journey that many would consider impossible for a young girl, walking kilometers through muddy roads just to reach Calamba National High School. The road is long and unrelenting. Some days, the sun beats down mercilessly, leaving her feet blistered and her skin raw. Other days, sudden tropical rain drenches her, soaking her uniform and weighing down her backpack. Yet Ritchel does not complain. Each step is fueled by a single goal: education and the hope of a brighter future

At home, her study space is modest. Notebooks share corners with sacks of rice and cooking pots, a daily reminder of the challenges she faces. Her parents, though struggling to make ends meet, give her something far more valuable than money - encouragement. “Anak, magpadayon ka. Ayaw undang,” they tell her every morning, and those words become her anchor. Despite the physical strain of her journey, Ritchel shines in the classroom. She is attentive, disciplined, and curious, always raising her hand to answer questions or help classmates understand lessons. Teachers praise her for her outstanding performance, noting that her determination sets her apart from many students.

Her classmates are equally inspired. They watch Ritchel arrive tired but smiling, ready to learn. For them, she is more than a peer; she is a symbol of resilience and courage. Her story reminds everyone that hard work and persistence can triumph over adversity. Ritchel’s journey is not just a walk to school; it is a lesson in perseverance. Each muddy path, each blistered foot, and each early morning is a step toward her dreams. She shows that obstacles, no matter how daunting, can be overcome with determination and heart.

She dreams not only of finishing high school but also of helping her family and giving back to her community. Her education is a tool to break the cycle of poverty, and she wields it with courage and discipline, refusing to let circumstances define her future. Her sleepers may wear thin, but her spirit never does. Every day she walks is a testament to hope, courage, and relentless determination. A reminder that success is earned through perseverance, not comfort. As Ritchel strides forward, rain or shine, barefooted in spirit if not literally, she teaches a lesson that resonates far beyond the classroom: ordinary beginnings, when paired with resilience and heart, can lead to extraordinary destinations.

“BEYOND THE YEARS: UNCLE BONG’S SECOND CHANCE AT LEARNING”

BY: JAMES HERMIE EVARDO



“It was difficult at first,” recalls Uncle Bong, his voice filled with both pride and humility. “But I was eager to learn. I wanted to show that age doesn’t matter in education only dedication and perseverance.” In the vibrant heart of Barangay Calamba, Cabadbaran City, where mornings are filled with the chatter of students and the hum of tricycles on the road, stands a man whose story redefines what it means to dream. At 47 years old, Uncle Bong is proving that it’s never too late to learn again. For many, classrooms belong to the young. But for him, school became a symbol of courage — a second chance to finish what life once interrupted. The Alternative Learning System (ALS) of Calamba National High School became his door back to education. Created by the Department of Education, ALS provides opportunities for those who missed formal schooling, giving them not only lessons but also renewed confidence and hope. Uncle Bong grew up in a small barangay in Agusan del Norte, where poverty was a daily battle. As a young boy, he dreamed of finishing school,

but the needs of his family came first. He worked from dawn until dusk to put food on the table, trading his notebooks for hard labor and setting aside his dreams. Years passed, but his heart never forgot the longing to learn. Each morning, as he drove his children to school, he felt a quiet pride and a hint of regret. His wife, Aunt Wing, noticed that spark of longing and urged him to enroll in the ALS program she heard about from a neighbor. Encouraged by her words, he finally gathered the courage to register. Returning to school after decades was not easy. The lessons were unfamiliar, the schedules tiring. He balanced being a father, a worker, and a student often staying up late to finish assignments. Yet, he never gave up. His classmates admired his perseverance, calling him “Tatay Bong,” the man who never surrendered. His teachers described him as the heart of the class active, responsible, and inspiring. “He reminds everyone that education has no age limit,” his teachers said with pride. “He is proof that learning is for all — young or old.” After years of hard work and dedication,

Uncle Bong graduated from the Alternative Learning System of Calamba National High School, Class of 2024. As he walked across the stage, tears glistened in his eyes. His wife and children cheered from the crowd, their pride shining brighter than any medal. “Education doesn’t belong only to the young,” he said softly. “It belongs to those who are willing to learn.” Uncle Bong’s journey is a testament that dreams delayed are not dreams denied. His story echoes a powerful truth — that learning has no deadline, and hope has no age. In every page of his notebook, in every lesson he embraced, he proved that it is never too late to begin again.

“COURAGE KNOWS NO
GENDER”
James Hermie Evardo

“They can call me names, judge me, even try to
bring me down but I will never let that stop me from
reaching my dreams.”
Randolph Beray, LGBTQIA student, Calamba
National High School

The classroom is quiet, but Randolph’s laughter cuts through the silence like sunlight through clouds. A joke, a kind word, a gesture of encouragement he gives them freely, as if carrying the weight of the world on his shoulders has taught him that joy is a choice. Yet behind that laughter lies a history of whispered insults, mocking stares, and days when being different felt like carrying a secret no one could understand.

Randolph Beray has learned early on that life can be unkind to those who refuse to fit a mold. Being an LGBTQIA student in a place where acceptance isn’t always immediate has tested him in ways others may never know. Some classmates sneer, some teachers may overlook him, and social expectations can feel like walls too high to climb. But Randolph does not see them as walls he sees them as challenges, opportunities to show courage quietly, every single day. At school, Randolph’s presence is impossible to ignore not because he demands attention, but because he gives it. He organizes events with care, cheers on classmates with genuine enthusiasm, and performs on stage with fearless pride. His classmates call him a “beacon of light,” and it is not just for his achievements it is for the way he lifts others, turning moments of despair into sparks of hope.

Poverty has been another shadow he has learned to face. Materials are scarce, resources limited, yet Randolph refuses to let these hardships define him. Late nights are spent poring over borrowed books, making up lessons missed, and studying with the determination of someone who knows that knowledge is the bridge to a brighter future. “I may not have everything,” he says softly, “but I have the will to succeed—and that is enough.”

Beyond the grades and the applause, Randolph carries a bigger dream: to become a teacher. To him, education is not just a personal goal; it is a way to empower others, to show students who may feel unseen or marginalized that being different is never a weakness. “I want every student to know their worth,” he says, eyes glimmering with hope, “no matter who they are or where they come from.”

What makes Randolph extraordinary is not just his resilience, but the joy and courage he radiates despite the adversity. Every smile, every kind word, every act of encouragement is a quiet rebellion against prejudice, a reminder that strength comes not from fitting in, but from standing tall.

Even on days when the world seems heavy, Randolph chooses kindness, courage, and perseverance. His story teaches that true bravery is not loud or grandiose it is gentle, persistent, and unwavering, seen in the way he treats others, in the way he works toward his dreams, and in the way he embraces his identity.

Randolph Beray’s life is more than a personal journey; it is a message. A message that being different is powerful, that dreams are valid for everyone, and that courage is not limited by gender or circumstance.

In a world that often misunderstands those who stand apart, Randolph shines like a light in the shadows a reminder that hope, joy, and authenticity can change the lives of many.



By: Ruvei Mhyr Monleon Guro

SST-II Calamba National High School
Cabadbaran City Division

AN ORDINARY TEACHER

She wakes before dawn, worn but brave,
Shaping a journey where dreams might pave.
A mother to none, yet to many she tends,
With lessons, with care, her love she lends.

By day, she stands in a classroom of light,
By night, she’s an online seller in the fight.
Selling her goods to make ends meet,
Balancing hope on weary feet.

She dreams of a child to call her own,
A longing she feels when she’s alone.
Her womb is silent, her heart aches loud,
Yet she nurtures others, unbowed, unproud.

The breadwinner’s role, a weight to bear,
With family problems and debts to spare.
Left and right loans, the bills pour,
Yet her spirit remains unshaken for sure.

At work, the pressures rise and press,
Deadlines, demands, unspoken stress.
In her heart, she carries the burden,
Teaching through joy, and sometimes pain.

She once held dreams of her perfect job then,
Now weathered by life’s unwavering rhythm.
Disappointments line her every year,
Yet still, she smiles, she perseveres.

She’s not just a teacher, she’s a dreamer too,
A sister, a friend, a breadwinner, endlessly true.

She holds the world on fragile wings,
A fighter who endures, and softly sings.

So here’s to the teacher, the seller, the guide,
Who hides her struggles, who swallows her pride.
An ordinary woman, extraordinary and strong,
Who carries the world as she marches all along.

FINDING HER VOICE: JESSA BELLA
MEA BUATIS CONQUERS STAGE
FRIGHT

James Hermie Evardo

The Gymnasium of Cabadbaran City buzzed with energy, a mix of excited chatter, nervous whispers, and the shuffle of papers. Students in crisp uniforms jostled for seats, judges focused intently on their notes, and teachers exchanged quiet remarks. Amid all this was Jessa Bella Mea Buatis, a Grade 9 student, clutching the edge of her skirt, her heart racing.

“I never thought I’d join Extemporaneous Speaking, Jessa Bella admitted, her voice trembling slightly. “Just thinking about speaking in front of people makes me nervous. Usually, I’m too shy even to answer in class.”

Shyness had long held Jessa Bella back, stopping her from sharing ideas or participating in school activities. But with guidance and encouragement from her coach, Michael Gucor, she decided to face her fear.

“Jessa Bella has a unique talent for ideas,” Coach Gucor said with a proud smile. “She just needs the confidence to express them. I never doubted that if she believed in herself, she could succeed.”

The competition began. Jessa Bella received her topic—a challenge she hadn’t expected. Her stomach twisted, her palms slick with sweat, and for a moment, she almost stepped back. But she drew a deep breath, straightened her posture, and began speaking.

At first, her voice shook, carrying the familiar tremor of fear. But as she continued, her words became stronger and clearer. Time seemed to pause in the gymnasium as everyone hung on to every idea she shared.

“I reminded myself, ‘Focus on the message, not the fear,’” Jessa Bella said afterward. “I imagined I was just talking to my friends, not the judges. That helped calm me down.”

By the end of her speech, she had transformed. The once-shy girl stood confident, articulating her ideas with clarity. When the judges announced she had won third place, applause filled the room. But for Jessa Bella, the real victory was silencing the doubts she had carried for so long. “As I heard the clapping, I realized I don’t have to let fear control my life,” she said with a bright smile. “If I can speak in front of an audience today, I can face other challenges with courage.” Her journey inspired her classmates, who had always seen her as quiet and reserved. Now, they witnessed her step onto the stage, speak her mind, and succeed a reminder that everyone has hidden strength to be discovered. “Jessa Bella’s story reminds us that growth begins when we step out of our comfort zone,” Coach Gucor said. “It’s not just about winning; it’s about discovering strengths we didn’t know we had.” For Jessabella, this experience was more than a competition. It was a journey of courage, perseverance, and self-discovery at first step toward confidence, empowerment, and finding her own voice. Walking off the stage, medal in hand and heart full of pride, Jessa Bella knew this was only the beginning. The girl who once feared speaking in class had not only conquered the competition but also her own fears and discovered the remarkable power of her voice

FINDING HER VOICE: JESSA BELLA
MEA BUATIS CONQUERS STAGE
FRIGHT
BY MAB

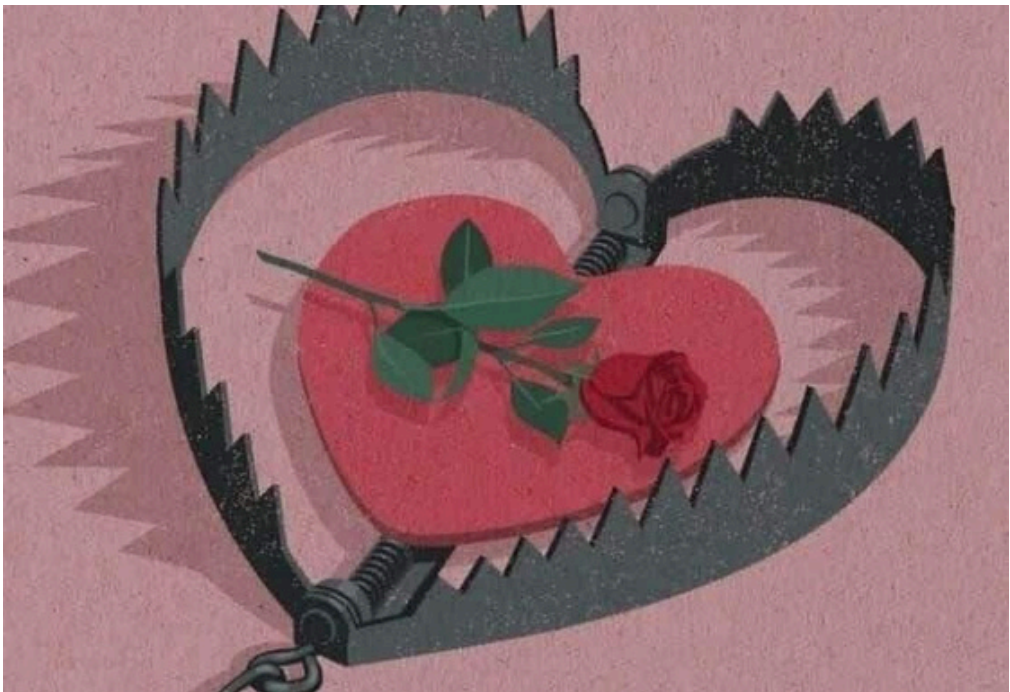
Corruption is not just a problem in government; it can quietly start right in our schools. It shows up when rules are bent for convenience, when some students gain advantages over others, or when decisions are made based on personal preference rather than fairness. Even small actions—like overlooking incomplete work or bending a minor rule—send a message that shortcuts are acceptable. While these may seem like minor things, they are early signs of habits that can shape a culture where fairness and honesty are not always practiced. The danger of these “petty” corruptions lies not in their size, but in the message they send. When students learn that shortcuts, favoritism, or bending rules are acceptable, they carry that mindset beyond the classroom. What starts as small tolerance in school corridors may eventually become a larger pattern in life.

Some might argue that these are minor issues compared to society’s bigger problems. But schools are where values are formed. Education is meant to reward effort, honesty, and fairness—not convenience or favoritism. If crooked seeds are allowed to take root in classrooms, how can we expect a future generation of honest leaders to grow? Responsibility is shared. Teachers must uphold fairness even with limited resources. Administrators must ensure transparency and accountability. And students must recognize that integrity matters more than an easy grade or temporary advantage. Ultimately, schools shape not only minds but also values. If we want a generation that stands tall against corruption, it starts with planting straight seeds in our classrooms. Every fair decision, every honest effort, and every act of integrity nurtures a tree that can grow strong and upright. After all, a crooked seed cannot grow a straight tree.

WHEN CONFESSIONS TURN TOXIC
BY JOHN OLIVER T. SUGANOB

It started as a harmless idea: a school confession wall where students could anonymously share thoughts, crushes, or funny experiences. A safe space to vent or laugh, right? But lately, some of these platforms have started to feel less like safe spaces and more like battlefields. Trolls—whether inside the school or external online accounts—are turning confessions into weapons, leaving many students hurt, embarrassed, or anxious. Troll farms are groups of people who deliberately post hurtful or inflammatory content online. In the context of school confession walls, this can mean bullying, spreading rumors, or even coordinating attacks on certain students. What was meant to be a place for connection has become a space for judgment and cruelty. And because it’s anonymous, people often say things they would never dare in person, thinking there are no consequences. The danger is not just in the posts themselves, but in the culture they create. Students begin to question their words, their

choices, and even their friendships. Confidence wanes when a harmless joke or honest confession becomes a target. For some, a single post can cause lasting anxiety or social isolation. Yet, this isn’t about banning confession walls or demonizing social media. These platforms can be positive spaces when used responsibly. Schools and students alike can set the tone: encourage respectful posts, moderate content, and teach digital empathy. Peer accountability matters too—when students report harmful posts or speak up against trolling, they help create a safer environment. Anonymity doesn’t have to mean cruelty. A confession wall can be a place for laughter, reflection, and connection—as long as kindness and respect are part of the rules. In the end, the responsibility is shared: every click, comment, and post shapes the culture of our digital school community. Together, we can turn these walls into places that reflect our best where everyone feels safe, heard, and valued. Let’s make it a culture worth being proud of.



WHEN LIGHT DRIVES AWAY THE DARK:
CAN LEDS OUTSMART RICE FIELD RATS?

MARIFE A. BOLONGAITA

Rice farmers in the Philippines face a persistent enemy in the rice field rat (*Rattus argentiventer*). These rodents destroy seedlings, damage panicles, and burrow into dikes, leading to significant yield losses. Traditional control methods such as chemical rodenticides, electrified barriers, and manual hunting can reduce rat populations but often harm the environment, require heavy labor, or pose safety risks.

Seeking a safer solution, student-researchers from Calamba National High School designed the Rice Field Rat Control Flashing LED Light Device, a solar-powered innovation that uses blue flashing lights to disperse rats without toxic chemicals. Research shows that rats avoid high light intensity and experience stress under flickering lights. According to Brudzynski (2023), rats demonstrate anxiety-like behaviors in brightly lit areas, while Shang (2021) found that prolonged LED exposure can damage their retinas, discouraging return to those locations.

Field tests in Barangay Bay-ang, Cabadbaran City confirmed the device’s effectiveness. Within four days, rat activity dropped sharply: from eight distress squeaks on the first night to only one by the fourth. The device, capable of covering up to 18 meters, blinked 60–90 times per minute which is an optimal rate to disorient rats. It is powered entirely by solar energy stored in its built-in panel.

Compared to sustained baiting with poisons or manual trapping, this flashing LED device offers a low-maintenance, eco-friendly alternative. It reduces reliance on harmful chemicals while requiring minimal farmer effort once installed. However, questions remain about its long-term durability in rice fields and whether rats may adapt to flashing lights over time. Further research on weather resistance and sustained performance is recommended.

This innovation signals a shift toward sustainable farming practices that prioritize both productivity and environmental care. By driving rats away with light instead of lethal chemicals, it not only protects crops but also promotes healthier environment. Now, can a simple flash of light truly become farming’s sustainable shield against one of its oldest foes?



RISING ABOVE THE WATERS: BUILDING A FLOOD-RESILIENT
PHILIPPINES

KATE LYNDEWEI B. SIDO

Not all heroes wear capes—some are made of concrete, steel, and science. In times of heavy rains and raging waters, flood control projects stand as heroes that keep our nation safe.

Every year, around 20 typhoons visit the Philippines, bringing heavy rains that overflow rivers, submerge towns, and wash away livelihoods. From Luzon to Mindanao, flooding has become a grim reality for many Filipinos, leaving scientists and engineers racing against time to create sustainable solutions.

Flood control refers to the use of engineering structures and environmental strategies to reduce the impact of flooding. These include drainage systems, flood walls, dams, dikes, river dredging, and reforestation. With proper planning and community cooperation, these projects can protect both urban centers and rural communities from devastating water surges.

One of the most important reasons for developing flood control systems is disaster risk reduction. When typhoons strike, floodwaters can rise rapidly, endangering people and cutting off access to essential services like hospitals, schools, and markets. Well-designed floodways and canals provide a path for excess water to safely flow away from residential areas, reducing the number of casualties and damages each year.

Beyond saving lives, flood control projects protect the economy and infrastructure. According to the Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH), billions of pesos are lost annually due to flood-related damages. Roads, bridges, and farmlands often bear the brunt of heavy rains. By improving drainage networks and building retention basins, the government ensures that transportation, agriculture, and local businesses continue to operate even during the rainy season.

Flood management also plays a key role in public health. Stagnant water after floods becomes a breeding ground for mosquitoes that cause dengue and malaria. Contaminated water sources may also lead to outbreaks of leptospirosis and diarrhea. With effective flood control systems, water can be drained more efficiently, reducing the risk of these post-flood diseases.

Environmental balance is another crucial factor. While concrete structures help divert floodwaters, green engineering solutions such as mangrove reforestation, urban green spaces, and rain gardens also contribute to natural flood absorption. These eco-friendly measures not only prevent flooding but also support biodiversity and cleaner air.

The Philippines has already implemented few major flood control projects, such as the Pasig-Marikina River Channel Improvement Project and the Taguig-Pateros Flood Control System. Meanwhile, local governments in provinces like Agusan del Norte and Pampanga are constructing small-scale flood barriers and rainwater catchment areas suited to their local geography.

However, infrastructure alone is not enough. Community awareness and participation are equally important. Residents should practice proper waste disposal, as clogged canals and drainage systems often worsen flooding. Schools and barangays must also educate citizens about flood preparedness and emergency response.

As climate change intensifies, stronger typhoons and heavier rainfall are expected in the coming years. Flood control projects, grounded in science, engineering, and cooperation within communities, offer our strongest protection. With collective effort, the Philippines can rise above the waters, protecting both its people and its future.

BRAIN DEVE-LOW-PMENT

Kate Lyndewei B. Sido

The Hidden Costs of Growing Up in Virtual Worlds

Kids are mastering digital worlds faster than ever, but real-life learning is lagging behind. Among the many popular online video games for today’s generation of youth, Roblox stands out as one of the most influential in the online gaming community. It is an online platform with millions of players from different parts of the world. It was created by David Baszucki, the CEO, together with his co-founder Erik Cassel, and was released in 2004. Their goal was for players to learn physics and engineering through interactive 3D simulations and creativity. It is popular among many because players can use their creativity to build things and experiences, and customize their avatars. They are also able to develop their social skills by interacting with other players. Its unique system allows users to earn and spend virtual currency called Robux, making gameplay even more engaging. However, this constant sense of reward is what traps young players into longer hours of play. In the Philippines, Roblox’s popularity continues to rise among the youth. According to the cybersecurity firm, Kaspersky, Roblox was the fourth most popular app among Filipino children with 13.67% listed Roblox as their most played app. With easy access to gadgets and the internet, more students are getting hooked on this digital gaming. As the numbers grow, so do the concerns about how this trend affects brain development. Studies show that long gaming sessions affect the brain’s ability to focus and store information. Constant exposure to fast-moving visuals overstimulates the senses, making slow, real-life learning feel boring. Teachers notice more students arriving sleepy, distracted, or unprepared. What once felt like fun now interferes with school and personal growth. Beyond academics, mental health also starts to decline. Many teens feel anxious, isolated, or frustrated when not playing, showing signs of dependence. The emotional attachment to gaming replaces genuine interaction with friends and family. Over time, this isolation leads to poor communication and delayed emotional development. Moderation remains the key to keeping gaming safe and enjoyable. Playing Roblox can boost creativity and teamwork when done responsibly. Parents and schools must guide children toward balancing screen time with real-life learning. After all, games should build minds, not break them.

TELEMEDICINE: BRINGING HEALTHCARE CLOSER TO HOME

Winjoy T. Saldivar

Your screen can now be turned into a doctor’s door, proving that good healthcare doesn’t always require a waiting room.

Telemedicine refers to the use of technology to deliver clinical care at a distance. It ensures that individuals receive healthcare when needed, especially those with limited access to medical facilities. Experts have been using telemedicine in clinical settings for decades, with the earliest documented references in medical literature dating back to the late 1950s and 1960s. Today, the practice has grown significantly; in fact, 76% of hospitals in the United States now connect with patients remotely through video conferencing or other technologies. As Brian Hasselfeld, M.D., assistant medical director for digital health innovations at Johns Hopkins Medicine, explains, “Health organizations are providing virtual appointments and are expanding their telehealth options, particularly in light of the COVID-19 pandemic.” The true value of telemedicine lies in the convenience it provides to both patients and healthcare providers. It eliminates the need for in-person visits for medical advice or treatment and is often more cost-effective than traditional consultations. This efficiency has made telemedicine an essential component of modern healthcare. Telemedicine comes in several forms. These include real-time communication through video calls; remote monitoring, which involves collecting, reporting, and evaluating health data such as blood pressure, cardiac activity, oxygen levels, and respiratory rates; and store-and-forward technology, which allows medical information like CAT scans, MRIs, X-rays, photos, videos, and text-based patient data to be stored and shared for later evaluation. Despite its many advantages, telemedicine also has important disadvantages. Limited internet access and unreliable connectivity can prevent patients from receiving consistent virtual care. Technical issues may interrupt consultations or reduce the quality of communication between patient and provider. Some medical concerns still require physical examinations or hands-on procedures, making telemedicine insufficient in certain cases. In addition, concerns about data privacy and cybersecurity continue to arise, as the storage and transfer of digital medical information may pose risks if systems are not adequately protected. In the Philippines, telemedicine is officially allowed and regulated through the joint efforts of the Department of Health (DOH), the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG), and the Philippine Health Insurance Corporation (PhilHealth). This is formalized under the DOH-DILG-PHIC Joint Administrative Order No. 2021-0001, titled “Guidelines on the Implementation of Telemedicine in the Delivery of Individual-Based Health Services,” which adopts the World Health Organization’s (WHO) definition of telemedicine. Telemedicine has transformed the way healthcare is delivered, making medical services more accessible, efficient, and patient-centered. While it offers significant benefits, acknowledging its limitations is vital. With increasing adoption worldwide and strong regulatory support in the Philippines, telemedicine continues to evolve, ensuring that quality healthcare remains just a click away.

WATT A BRIGHT FUTURE THE PHILIPPINES’ 2040 GLOW-UP POWERED BY RENEWABLE RESOURCES

Kate Lyndewei B. Sido

Renewable resources are energy resources that come from nature and can be used again and again. These include sunlight, wind, water, and heat from the Earth. Around the globe, nations are trying to shift away from fossil fuels to embrace energy sources that are natural, sustainable, and kind to the Earth. Many years ago, the world relied heavily on coal, oil, and gas to produce electricity. These resources, while powerful, released large amounts of smoke and carbon into the atmosphere, warming the planet and harming nature. Even today, roughly 80% of our energy comes from oil, coal, and natural gas, based on data from the U.S. Energy Information Administration. According to the United Nations, the scientific consensus is clear: to prevent the most serious consequences of climate change, global emissions must be cut by nearly half by 2030 and reach net-zero by 2050. To make this possible, we must move away from fossil fuels and invest in clean, accessible, affordable, sustainable, and dependable alternative energy sources. Now, the Philippines is steadily strengthening its commitment to renewable energy, placing strong emphasis on solar power. This effort is driven by the Department of Energy’s (DOE) Renewable Portfolio Standard (RPS), which requires electricity providers to obtain a set portion of their supply from renewable sources. The DOE aims for renewable energy to make up 50% of the nation’s power generation mix by 2040. With targets of 35% renewable energy by 2030 and 50% by 2040, the Philippines is placing solar power at the center of its strategy due to its abundance and affordability. The country’s strong solar irradiance makes it highly suitable for solar energy development, as noted in various reports on solar advancements in the Philippines. Recent data also shows that renewable energy now contributes nearly 30% of the nation’s total installed capacity, reflecting significant and accelerating progress. Recently, the DOE revealed the fourth round of the Green Energy Auction Program (GEAP), which seeks to acquire 2,927 megawatts (MW) of renewable energy capacity. Of this total, solar power makes up the majority at 2,727 MW, while the remaining capacity is allocated to wind (100 MW), run-of-river hydro (50 MW), and biomass (50 MW). Efforts by the DOE, such as the RPS and GEAP, are reshaping the Philippines’ energy sector by accelerating the adoption of renewable power. With ongoing investment and technological advancements, the country is positioning itself as a renewable energy leader in Southeast Asia. The DOE’s ambitious goals, along with its strong emphasis on solar development, are guiding our nation toward a more sustainable and resilient energy future. By maximizing its abundant natural resources, the Philippines is also establishing a model for other countries in the region to follow. By embracing renewable energy today, the Philippines is lighting the way toward a greener and more secure tomorrow. With continued commitment, the nation can build an energy system that protects both people and the planet.

DETERMINATION PAYS OFF: BENIGA DOMINATES GIRLS' WEIGHTLIFTING SNATCH CATEGORY

CABADBARAN CITY, Agusan del Norte — Local talent Jessa Beniga delivered an impressive performance in the Girls' Weightlifting Snatch Category Division Meet 2025, held November 13, 2025, at the Cabadbaran City National High School (CCNHS) Astrodome Beniga emerged as the standout competitor, claiming the coveted gold medal amidst a challenging field.

The Gold Medal Performance Beniga's victory was a testament to her consistent strength and focus. In her final attempt, she successfully lifted 55 kilograms solidifying her first-place finish. Her dominant showing earned her the top spot on the podium and an outright slot to the Regional Meet next year.

Her journey to the top was not easy, as she faced multiple failed attempts throughout the event. During the initial two rounds, Beniga struggled to match her practice weights, creating palpable tension among the spectators and her coaches.

Will Despite these setbacks, Beniga showed a remarkable resilience and an unwavering determination to succeed. She quickly regrouped, focused on her technique, and relied on her mental fortitude to block out the pressure from the competition.



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RED DRAGONS CLINCH CHAMPIONSHIP SPOT AFTER THRILLING VICTORY OVER YELLOW LIONS

Red Dragons shattered the Yellow Lions in a nerve-wracking Boys' Basketball "PANGSANGKA" tournament semifinal with the final score of 62-57 at the Brgy. Calamba Covered Court on September 15, 2025. The hard-fought victory secured the Red Dragons a coveted spot to compete for the championship title.

Red Dragons opened the game with explosive energy. In the first quarter, star guards Jacob Ladaga and Kylie Saguran showcased their brilliance as they pulled off a 4-point lead early on, dominating the offensive tempo. Their aggressive fast breaks and tight defense stunned the Yellow Lions' initial lineup.

Red Dragons Maintain the Edge However, the Yellow Lions did not let up and worked even harder—determined to win the clash. Despite the Lions' relentless effort to close the gap, the first quarter ended with the Red Dragons on the lead, 13-16.

The momentum drastically shifted in the second quarter. Fueled by their roaring supporters who came in full force, the Yellow Lions' defense intensified. They managed to force several crucial turnovers and converted them into fast-break points. That was the reason the Yellow Lions won the second quarter, 35-34, giving them a slim one-point lead heading into the second half.

In the third quarter was filled with undeniable tension. The Yellow Lions suffered a major setback when two of their greatest players—Ladaga and Saguran—briefly got injured. The Red Dragons took the chance to strike back, reorganizing their lineup and relying on their bench players. They scored 15 points in the quarter, regaining the lead, 49-45.

Ladaga's Resurgence and Impact Fortunately for the Dragons, Ladaga and Saguran quickly returned to the court with renewed intensity. Throughout the third quarter, Ladaga also gained 7 points and plucked 4 crucial rebounds, while Saguran shot consecutively, earning 4 points and 3 assists. Their combined effort neutralized the Lions' attempt at a comeback.

The Final Quarter Thriller Energized by their win in the third quarter, the Red Dragons scored the first point of the final frame, but the Yellow Lions fiercely clawed back. The intensity peaked when the Red Dragons tied with the Yellow Lions at 57-all, setting the stage for a tense endgame.

The Game-Winning Play With three minutes left in the fourth quarter, veteran forward Hyde Dacera nailed a 3-pointer, giving the Dragons a much-needed buffer. Together with forward Jayson Robin, who fired up 2 points, they secured the Red Dragons' chance to compete for the championship, pushing the final score to 62-57.

Looking Ahead The Red Dragons now advance to the "PANGSANGKA" Championship Finals, where they will face the winner of the second semifinal match. The Yellow Lions, despite the loss, finished the tournament with an impressive record and displayed true sportsmanship throughout the game. The community eagerly anticipates the final showdown next week.

RED DRAGONS CLINCH CHAMPIONSHIP SPOT AFTER THRILLING VICTORY OVER YELLOW LIONS

A blazing kick from Aj Bitoon resulted the Blue Falcons to successfully overthrow the two years straight champions, Red Dragon, 2-0 (15-6,15-14) in the Mens Sepak Takraw PANAGSANGKA 2025 at Calamba National High School, September 2025.In the first set Blue Falcons Snatch the Crown From Red Dragons, 2-0

A blazing kick from AJ paved the way for the Blue Falcons to overthrow the two-year defending champions, Red Dragons, securing a 2-0 victory (15-6, 15-14) in the Men's Sepak Takraw match during the PANAGSANGKA 2025, held at Calamba National High School, September 2025.

In the first set, the Blue Falcons immediately displayed their brilliance as they pulled off an early 4-point lead.

Christian James Cresino contributed crucial points, but the Red Dragons attempted to close the gap. Despite this, the Blue Falcons remained determined to dominate the clash

Moreover, the Blue Falcons did not let up—they pushed even harder, sealing the first set at 15-6 through powerful serves, quick reflexes, and excellent coordination.

The second set became even more thrilling, filled with undeniably strong tension between both teams.

The Red Dragons grew increasingly aggressive, fighting hard to defend their title and pushing the Falcons into several tight rallies.

However, the Blue Falcons maintained composure and showed exceptional teamwork.

A series of well-executed blocks and counter-kicks allowed them to survive the Red Dragons' late surge.

The intense set ended with a narrow 15-14 finish, completing the Falcons' 2-0 sweep and officially dethroning the long-time champions.

According to AJ, their victory was the product of discipline, daily training, and their coach's guidance.

Their team hopes to continue this winning momentum as they move forward in the tournament.

CALABDIS ROOKIE OBONGEN SECURES TWO SILVERS IN THROWING EVENTS

Lead/Summary CABADBARAN CITY, Agusan del Norte — First-time silver rookie and Cabadbaran District (CALABDIS) player Jess Anthony Obongen bagged a silver medal in the Boys’ Discus Throw during the Division Athletic Meet 2025. The competition was held yesterday, November 13, at Caraga State University-Cabadbaran City (CSUC-Cabadbaran).

The Double Silver Haul Though considered a newcomer to the division, Obongen made an immediate impact, claiming two silver medals—one each in the Discus Throw and the Shotput events. His exceptional performance across both technical disciplines surprised veteran coaches and solidified his reputation as a formidable thrower.

Discus Throw Performance Obongen proudly secured second place in the highly competitive Discus Throw event. He impressed everyone with his remarkable throw at the circular plate, maintaining strong form and technique throughout his attempts.

Key Measurement and Achievement In his final successful throw, Obongen reached an impressive distance of 21.61 meters, showcasing both his sheer strength and unyielding determination. This mark was a personal best for the young athlete and narrowly missed the gold medal distance by less than a meter. Success Following his success in the discus,



Obongen carried his momentum into the Shotput event. Despite the change in equipment and throwing motion, he demonstrated consistency and power, earning his second silver medal. This versatility highlights his potential as a multi-event field athlete. Rookie Status and Impact As a rookie, Obongen's achievement is particularly significant. His preparation and discipline allowed him to compete at the highest level of the division immediately. His double silver win contributes significantly to the overall medal tally of the CALABDIS delegation.

Mr. Raymon R. Owapin his coach noted that the athlete faced stiff competition, particularly from the more experienced players of the Cabadbaran City Division. "Jess’s success is a result of consistent early morning training sessions focusing on core strength and explosive power," the coach stated. "We focused heavily on refining his footwork, which proved key in maximizing his distance." With his two silver medals, Jess Anthard Obongen is now set to represent the division at the upcoming Regional Athletic Meet. His team anticipates that with further refinement of his technique and increased training loads, he stands a strong chance of bringing home medals from the higher level of competition.

RED DRAGONS CLINCH CHAMPIONSHIP SPOT AFTER THRILLING VICTORY OVER YELLOW LIONS

Red Dragons shattered the Yellow Lions in a nerve-wracking Boys’ Basketball "PANGSANGKA" tournament semifinal with the final score of 62-57 at the Brgy. Calamba Covered Court on September 15, 2025. The hard-fought victory secured the Red Dragons a coveted spot to compete for the championship title. Red Dragons opened the game with explosive energy. In the first quarter, star guards Jacob Ladaga and Kylle Saguran showcased their brilliance as they pulled off a 4-point lead early on, dominating the offensive tempo. Their aggressive fast breaks and tight defense stunned the Yellow Lions' initial lineup. Red Dragons Maintain the Edge However, the Yellow Lions did not let up and worked even harder—determined to win the clash. Despite the Lions' relentless effort to close the gap, the first quarter ended with the Red Dragons on the lead, 13-16. The momentum drastically shifted in the second quarter. Fueled by their roaring supporters who came in full force, the Yellow Lions' defense intensified. They managed to force several crucial turnovers and converted them into fast-break points. That was the reason the Yellow Lions won the second quarter, 35-34, giving them a slim one-point lead heading into the second half.

In the third quarter was filled with undeniable tension. The Yellow Lions suffered a major setback when two of their greatest players—Ladaga and Saguran—briefly got injured. The Red Dragons took the chance to strike back, reorganizing their lineup and relying on their bench players. They scored 15 points in the quarter, regaining the lead, 49-45. Ladaga's Resurgence and Impact Fortunately for the Dragons, Ladaga and Saguran quickly returned to the court with renewed intensity. Throughout the third quarter, Ladaga also gained 7 points and plucked 4 crucial rebounds, while Saguran shot consecutively, earning 4 points and 3 assists. Their combined effort neutralized the Lions' attempt at a comeback. The Final Quarter Thriller Energized by their win in the third quarter, the Red Dragons scored the first point of the final frame, but the Yellow Lions fiercely clawed back. The intensity peaked when the Red Dragons tied with the Yellow Lions at 57-all, setting the stage for a tense endgame. The Game-Winning Play With three minutes left in the fourth quarter, veteran forward Hyde Dacera nailed a 3-pointer, giving the Dragons a much-needed buffer. Together with forward Jayson Robin, who fired up 2 points, they secured the Red Dragons' chance to compete for the championship, pushing the final score to 62-57. Looking Ahead The Red Dragons now advance to the "PANGSANGKA" Championship Finals, where they will face the winner of the second semifinal match. The Yellow Lions, despite the loss, finished the tournament with an impressive record and displayed true sportsmanship throughout the game. The community eagerly anticipates the final showdown next weekk.

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A blazing kick from Aj Bitoon resulted the Blue Falcons to successfully overthrow the two years straight champions, Red Dragon, 2-0 (15-6,15-14) in the Mens Sepak Takraw PANAGSANGKA 2025 at Calamba National High School, September 2025.In the first set Blue Falcons Snatch the Crown From Red Dragons, 2-0 A blazing kick from AJ paved the way for the Blue Falcons to overthrow the two-year defending champions, Red Dragons, securing a 2-0 victory (15-6, 15-14) in the Men’s Sepak Takraw match during the PANAGSANGKA 2025, held at Calamba National High School, September 2025. In the first set, the Blue Falcons immediately displayed their brilliance as they pulled off an early 4-point lead. Christian James Cresino contributed crucial points, but the Red Dragons attempted to close the gap. Despite this, the Blue Falcons remained determined to dominate the clash

Moreover, the Blue Falcons did not let up—they pushed even harder, sealing the first set at 15-6 through powerful serves, quick reflexes, and excellent coordination. The second set became even more thrilling, filled with undeniably strong tension between both teams. The Red Dragons grew increasingly aggressive, fighting hard to defend their title and pushing the Falcons into several tight rallies. However, the Blue Falcons maintained composure and showed exceptional teamwork. A series of well-executed blocks and counter-kicks allowed them to survive the Red Dragons’ late surge. The intense set ended with a narrow 15-14 finish, completing the Falcons’ 2-0 sweep and officially dethroning the long-time champions. According to AJ, their victory was the product of discipline, daily training, and their coach’s guidance. Their team hopes to continue this winning momentum as they move forward in the tournament.